Yashwant Cherukuri

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Education

University of California Berkeley **Berkeley, CA**

Bachelor of Science in Engineering: Engineering Undeclared *August 2025 - May 2029*

Experience

Ascend Consulting Group **August 2025 – Current**

Consultant *Berkeley, CA*

- Conduct Gen-Z consumer behavior research for VC-backed startups, analyzing market trends and delivering actionable insights to inform product strategy and go-to-market decisions.
- Collaborate with cross-functional teams to synthesize quantitative data and qualitative feedback into comprehensive client deliverables and strategic recommendations.

Northrop Grumman **August 2022 – May 2025**

Balloon Systems Engineer, HIP Program - Project Icarus *Rolling Meadows, IL*

- Designed and optimized stratospheric balloon launches using atmospheric modeling and flight prediction software, calculating ascent/descent rates, launch windows, and trajectory to maximize data collection quality.
- Procured and integrated payload components including sensors for air chemistry, temperature, pressure, GPS, and solar radiation; obtained Ham radio license to enable real-time telemetry and tracking.
- Executed 97-minute high-altitude flight reaching 70,000 ft, collecting environmental data analyzed in Excel to generate visualizations and actionable insights; presented findings to Northrop Grumman engineering staff, influencing design considerations for future experiments.

Brewhaha Student-run Coffee Shop **August 2021 – May 2025**

Manager, Head of Marketing *Rolling Meadows, IL*

- Managed student-run social enterprise generating $10,000+ annual revenue, overseeing daily operations, inventory management, and a 6-person volunteer team.
- Increased daily revenue 67% ($120 to $200+) by expanding product offerings based on customer surveys and implementing seasonal specials and promotional campaigns.
- Reduced DECA chapter participation costs by 2-3x compared to neighboring schools through strategic fundraising and cost management, improving accessibility for 120+ members.

Leadership

DECA - Rolling Meadows Chapter **August 2021 – May 2025**

- Scaled chapter membership 4x from 30 to 120+ students through targeted recruitment strategy emphasizing experiential benefits over purely professional outcomes, achieving gender parity and significantly increased demographic diversity.
- Achieved top 20 global ranking at DECA ICDC and Illinois State Championship in Business Services Marketing, becoming first student in over a decade to compete internationally and most accomplished competitor in chapter history
- Built systematic training infrastructure, increasing state qualifiers 40% (15 to 21 students) through structured mock sessions, workshops, and peer mentoring programs.

Projects

Quantitative Portfolio Analysis | *Github: github.com/YashwantC26/quantitative-portfolio-analysis* **January 2026**

- Developed factor investing backtesting framework analyzing 5 quantitative strategies (Value, Momentum, Quality, Size, Low Volatility) across 6 years of historical market data (2019-2025).
- Engineered data pipeline using Yahoo Finance API to fetch and process stock prices, returns, and fundamental metrics (P/E, P/B, ROE, market cap) for 20+ large-cap securities.
- Implemented z-score normalization and portfolio optimization algorithms with monthly rebalancing simulation and 0.1% transaction costs.
- Calculated comprehensive performance metrics (Sharpe ratio, alpha, beta, max drawdown) and generated statistical visualizations comparing risk-adjusted returns vs S&P 500 benchmark.

Honors

Model UN of the University of Chicago (MUNUC) International Honorable Mention (Top 5/300+ delegates), DECA International Finalist and State Champion, Illinois State Scholar, Graduated with Highest Honors, AP Scholar